

Bible Study Workbook for Beginners

*Your Complete Guide to Understanding, Studying,
and Applying God's Word*

A Step-by-Step Workbook

Perfect for new believers, curious seekers,
and anyone wanting to go deeper in Scripture

Welcome to Bible Study!

Congratulations on taking this step! Whether you are a brand new Christian, someone returning to faith, or simply curious about what the Bible says, this workbook will guide you through the basics of studying God's Word in a way that is practical, engaging, and life-changing.

What you'll learn:

- * How the Bible is organized (Old Testament & New Testament)
- * Different methods of Bible study (SOAP, Inductive, Topical)
- * How to understand context, culture, and application
- * Key Bible stories and themes you need to know
- * How to apply what you read to your daily life
- * How to develop a consistent Bible reading habit

*"All Scripture is God-breathed and is useful for teaching, rebuking,"
correcting and training in righteousness.*

-- 2 Timothy 3:16

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Introduction & Welcome	2
Part 1: Understanding the Bible (Overview)	4
Part 2: Bible Study Methods	10
Part 3: Key Stories & Themes	18
Part 4: Books of the Bible Guide	26
Part 5: Practical Application	34
Part 6: Building Your Bible Habit	40
Journal & Notes Pages	44

Part 1: Understanding the Bible

How is the Bible organized?

The Bible is a library of 66 books written by about 40 authors over 1,500 years. Yet it tells one unified story: God's love for humanity and His plan to save us through Jesus Christ.

The Bible is divided into two main parts:

OLD TESTAMENT (39 books) - Before Jesus

- * Law (Genesis-Deuteronomy): God's rules and Israel's beginning
- * History (Joshua-Esther): Israel's story as a nation
- * Poetry (Job-Song of Solomon): Wisdom, worship, and life
- * Prophets (Isaiah-Malachi): God's messengers and warnings

NEW TESTAMENT (27 books) - Jesus and After

- * Gospels (Matthew-John): The life and teachings of Jesus
- * Acts: The early church's story
- * Letters (Romans-Jude): Teaching for Christians
- * Revelation: The future and God's ultimate victory

Where should a beginner start?

Start with the Gospel of John (the story of Jesus), then read Genesis (the beginning), then Psalms (prayers and worship), then Romans (core Christian beliefs).

Exercise: Bible Overview

Fill in what you know (don't worry if you can't answer all):

How many books are in the Bible total?

What are the first 5 books called?

Name the 4 Gospels:

Who wrote most of the New Testament letters?

What is the longest book in the Bible?

What is the shortest book?

Where would you find the 10 Commandments?

What book tells the story of Jesus' birth?

Part 2: Bible Study Methods

Method 1: SOAP Method

S - Scripture

Write out the verse or passage that stands out to you

O - Observation

What do you notice? Who is speaking? What is happening?

A - Application

How does this apply to your life today?

P - Prayer

Write a prayer based on what you learned

Method 2: 5 W's + H Method

- * WHO is speaking/being spoken to?
- * WHAT is happening in this passage?
- * WHEN did this take place?
- * WHERE is this happening?
- * WHY is this important?
- * HOW does this apply to me?

SOAP Practice: John 3:16

"For God so loved the world that He gave His one and only Son, that whoever believes in Him shall not perish but have eternal life.

-- John 3:16

S - Scripture (Write it in your own words):

O - Observation (What do you notice?):

A - Application (How does this apply to YOUR life?):

P - Prayer (Write a prayer based on this verse):

SOAP Practice: Psalm 23:1-3

*"The LORD is my shepherd, I lack nothing. He makes me lie down in green"
pastures, He leads me beside quiet waters, He refreshes my soul.*

-- Psalm 23:1-3

S - Scripture (Write it in your own words):

O - Observation (What do you notice?):

A - Application (How does this apply to YOUR life?):

P - Prayer (Write a prayer based on this verse):

SOAP Practice: Philippians 4:13

"I can do all this through Him who gives me strength."

-- Philippians 4:13

S - Scripture (Write it in your own words):

O - Observation (What do you notice?):

A - Application (How does this apply to YOUR life?):

P - Prayer (Write a prayer based on this verse):

SOAP Practice: Jeremiah 29:11

"For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper" you and not to harm you, plans to give you hope and a future.

-- Jeremiah 29:11

S - Scripture (Write it in your own words):

O - Observation (What do you notice?):

A - Application (How does this apply to YOUR life?):

P - Prayer (Write a prayer based on this verse):

SOAP Practice: Romans 8:28

*"And we know that in all things God works for the good of those who love"
Him, who have been called according to His purpose.*

-- Romans 8:28

S - Scripture (Write it in your own words):

O - Observation (What do you notice?):

A - Application (How does this apply to YOUR life?):

P - Prayer (Write a prayer based on this verse):

Part 3: Key Bible Stories to Know

Creation (Genesis 1-2)

God made everything and it was good

The Fall (Genesis 3)

Sin entered the world through disobedience

Noah's Ark (Genesis 6-9)

God saved the faithful through the flood

Abraham's Call (Genesis 12)

God chose a people for Himself

The Exodus (Exodus 14)

God delivered His people from slavery

David & Goliath (1 Samuel 17)

Faith overcomes impossible odds

The Birth of Jesus (Luke 2)

God became human to save us

Jesus' Teachings (Matthew 5-7)

How to live in God's kingdom

The Cross (John 19)

Jesus died for our sins

The Resurrection (John 20)

Jesus conquered death

Pentecost (Acts 2)

The Holy Spirit came to believers

Paul's Conversion (Acts 9)

God transforms the worst sinners

Key Stories Worksheet

Read ONE story from the list and answer:

Story I read: _____

What happened in this story?

What does this teach me about God?

What does this teach me about people?

How does this connect to Jesus?

What can I apply to my life today?

Part 4: Books of the Bible Quick Guide

OLD TESTAMENT

- * Genesis - The beginning of everything
- * Exodus - God rescues Israel from Egypt
- * Psalms - Songs of worship and prayer
- * Proverbs - Practical wisdom for life
- * Isaiah - The coming Messiah prophesied
- * Jeremiah - God's faithfulness in judgment
- * Daniel - Faith under pressure

NEW TESTAMENT

- * Matthew - Jesus as King
- * Mark - Jesus as Servant
- * Luke - Jesus as perfect human
- * John - Jesus as God
- * Acts - The early church's story
- * Romans - Core Christian theology
- * 1 Corinthians - Church problems and solutions
- * Ephesians - Our identity in Christ
- * Philippians - Joy in all circumstances
- * James - Faith in action
- * Revelation - God's ultimate victory

Part 5: Your First Reading Plan

Here is a 14-day reading plan perfect for beginners. Check off each day as you complete it:

- ☐ Day 1: John 1 - Jesus is the Word
- ☐ Day 2: John 3 - You must be born again
- ☐ Day 3: John 4 - The woman at the well
- ☐ Day 4: John 10 - The Good Shepherd
- ☐ Day 5: John 11 - Jesus raises Lazarus
- ☐ Day 6: John 13-14 - The Last Supper
- ☐ Day 7: John 19-20 - The Cross & Resurrection
- ☐ Day 8: Genesis 1-2 - Creation
- ☐ Day 9: Genesis 3 - The Fall
- ☐ Day 10: Psalm 23 - The LORD is my shepherd
- ☐ Day 11: Psalm 91 - God's protection
- ☐ Day 12: Romans 3 - All have sinned
- ☐ Day 13: Romans 8 - Nothing separates us from God
- ☐ Day 14: Ephesians 2 - Saved by grace

Part 6: Building Your Bible Habit

Tips for Daily Bible Reading:

- ☐ Choose a consistent time (morning is best for most people)
- ☐ Start small - even 5 minutes counts!
- ☐ Find a quiet, comfortable place
- ☐ Keep a journal or notebook nearby
- ☐ Use a Bible reading plan to stay on track
- ☐ Don't try to understand everything at once
- ☐ Ask God to speak to you before you read
- ☐ Talk to someone about what you're learning

My Bible Study Commitment:

I will read my Bible at: _____ (time)

In this place: _____

For at least: _____ minutes per day

Starting: _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Bible Study Notes

Date: _____ Passage: _____

S - Scripture:

O - Observation:

A - Application:

P - Prayer:

Bible Study Notes

Date: _____ Passage: _____

S - Scripture:

O - Observation:

A - Application:

P - Prayer:

Bible Study Notes

Date: _____ Passage: _____

S - Scripture:

O - Observation:

A - Application:

P - Prayer:

Key Verses to Memorize

Start by memorizing these foundational verses. Check each one off as you learn it:

- ☐ John 3:16 - For God so loved the world...
- ☐ Romans 3:23 - For all have sinned and fall short...
- ☐ Romans 6:23 - For the wages of sin is death...
- ☐ Ephesians 2:8-9 - For it is by grace you have been saved...
- ☐ Philippians 4:13 - I can do all things through Christ...
- ☐ Jeremiah 29:11 - For I know the plans I have for you...
- ☐ Proverbs 3:5-6 - Trust in the LORD with all your heart...
- ☐ Romans 8:28 - All things work together for good...
- ☐ Isaiah 41:10 - Fear not, for I am with you...
- ☐ Psalm 23:1 - The LORD is my shepherd, I lack nothing...
- ☐ Matthew 28:19-20 - Go and make disciples of all nations...
- ☐ Galatians 5:22-23 - The fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace...

Topical Study Guide

When you face specific situations, here's where to look in the Bible:

When you're afraid:

Psalm 91, Isaiah 41:10, 2 Timothy 1:7

When you're sad:

Psalm 34:18, Matthew 5:4, Revelation 21:4

When you need wisdom:

James 1:5, Proverbs 2:6, Psalm 119:105

When you feel alone:

Deuteronomy 31:6, Psalm 139, Matthew 28:20

When you're tempted:

1 Corinthians 10:13, James 4:7, Hebrews 4:15-16

When you need peace:

Philippians 4:6-7, John 14:27, Isaiah 26:3

When you need strength:

Isaiah 40:31, Philippians 4:13, 2 Corinthians 12:9

When you need forgiveness:

1 John 1:9, Psalm 103:12, Romans 8:1

When you're grateful:

Psalm 100, 1 Thessalonians 5:18, Psalm 107:1

When facing decisions:

Proverbs 3:5-6, James 1:5, Psalm 32:8

Bible Reading Tracker

Track your daily Bible reading. Color in or check off each day you read:

Month: _____

Week 1:

☐ Mon ☐ Tue ☐ Wed ☐ Thu ☐ Fri ☐ Sat ☐ Sun

Passage read: _____

Week 2:

☐ Mon ☐ Tue ☐ Wed ☐ Thu ☐ Fri ☐ Sat ☐ Sun

Passage read: _____

Week 3:

☐ Mon ☐ Tue ☐ Wed ☐ Thu ☐ Fri ☐ Sat ☐ Sun

Passage read: _____

Week 4:

☐ Mon ☐ Tue ☐ Wed ☐ Thu ☐ Fri ☐ Sat ☐ Sun

Passage read: _____

Week 5:

☐ Mon ☐ Tue ☐ Wed ☐ Thu ☐ Fri ☐ Sat ☐ Sun

Passage read: _____

Days read this month: ____ / 30

Favorite passage this month:

Understanding Bible Context

Context is KEY to understanding the Bible correctly. Always ask these questions:

1. Historical Context

When was this written? What was happening in the world at that time? What culture were the people living in?

2. Literary Context

What comes before and after this passage? What type of writing is this (history, poetry, prophecy, letter)?

3. Author's Intent

Who wrote this? Who were they writing to? What problem were they addressing?

4. The Big Picture

How does this passage fit into the overall story of the Bible? How does it point to Jesus?

Common Mistakes to Avoid:

- X Taking a verse out of context to prove a point
- X Ignoring the original audience and culture
- X Reading modern ideas back into ancient texts
- X Cherry-picking verses while ignoring surrounding passages
- X Treating poetry/metaphor as literal history (or vice versa)

My Personal Bible Study Plan

After completing this workbook, here's my ongoing plan:

Daily time commitment: _____ minutes

Time of day: _____

Place: _____

Bible translation I'll use: _____

Study method I'll use: _____

Book I'll start with: _____

Accountability partner: _____

My 3-month Bible reading goals:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

My 1-year Bible reading goals:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

The Gospel in Simple Terms

The entire Bible tells ONE story. Here it is in 5 parts:

1. CREATION

God created everything good. He made people to know and love Him. (Genesis 1-2)

2. THE FALL

Humanity chose to disobey God (sin), breaking our relationship with Him. Every person is affected by sin. (Genesis 3, Romans 3:23)

3. THE PROMISE

God promised to send a Savior who would fix what was broken. The entire Old Testament points to this coming Rescuer. (Genesis 3:15, Isaiah 53)

4. JESUS

God Himself came as a human - Jesus. He lived a perfect life, died on the cross to pay for our sins, and rose from the dead. (John 1:14, Romans 5:8, 1 Cor 15:3-4)

5. RESTORATION

Through faith in Jesus, we are forgiven and restored to relationship with God. One day He will make ALL things new. (Ephesians 2:8-9, Revelation 21:5)

Your Response:

Have you personally accepted this gift? Write your thoughts:

Common Questions New Believers Ask

Q: How do I know I'm saved?

A: If you have believed in Jesus and received Him as Lord, you are saved (John 1:12, Romans 10:9). Salvation is a gift, not earned by works.

Q: What if I still sin?

A: Christians still struggle with sin, but the Holy Spirit helps us grow. Confess, repent, and trust God's grace (1 John 1:9).

Q: How do I pray?

A: Prayer is simply talking to God. You can pray anytime, anywhere. Be honest - He already knows your heart (Matthew 6:9-13).

Q: Which Bible translation should I use?

A: Start with an easy-to-read version like NIV, NLT, or ESV. The best Bible is one you actually read!

Q: Do I need to go to church?

A: Yes! Church is where you grow, serve, and find community. You need other believers (Hebrews 10:25).

Q: How do I know God's will?

A: Read His Word, pray, seek wise counsel, and pay attention to the Holy Spirit's leading (Proverbs 3:5-6).

Word Study Worksheet

Choose a key word from your reading (like 'grace', 'faith', 'love', 'hope') and explore it deeply:

My word: _____

Dictionary definition:

How is it used in this passage?

Other verses that use this word:

What does this word mean for my life?

How can I live this word out today?

SOAP Practice: Matthew 6:33

*"But seek first His kingdom and His righteousness, and all these things will
be given to you as well."*

-- Matthew 6:33

S - Scripture (Write it in your own words):

O - Observation (What do you notice?):

A - Application (How does this apply to YOUR life?):

P - Prayer (Write a prayer based on this verse):

SOAP Practice: Isaiah 40:31

"But those who hope in the LORD will renew their strength. They will soar on wings like eagles.

-- Isaiah 40:31

S - Scripture (Write it in your own words):

O - Observation (What do you notice?):

A - Application (How does this apply to YOUR life?):

P - Prayer (Write a prayer based on this verse):

SOAP Practice: Hebrews 11:1

"Now faith is confidence in what we hope for and assurance about what we do" not see.

-- Hebrews 11:1

S - Scripture (Write it in your own words):

O - Observation (What do you notice?):

A - Application (How does this apply to YOUR life?):

P - Prayer (Write a prayer based on this verse):

SOAP Practice: James 1:2-4

"Consider it pure joy whenever you face trials, because the testing of your faith produces perseverance."

-- James 1:2-4

S - Scripture (Write it in your own words):

O - Observation (What do you notice?):

A - Application (How does this apply to YOUR life?):

P - Prayer (Write a prayer based on this verse):

SOAP Practice: Psalm 46:10

"Be still, and know that I am God."

-- Psalm 46:10

S - Scripture (Write it in your own words):

O - Observation (What do you notice?):

A - Application (How does this apply to YOUR life?):

P - Prayer (Write a prayer based on this verse):

SOAP Practice: 1 Peter 5:7

"Cast all your anxiety on Him because He cares for you."

-- 1 Peter 5:7

S - Scripture (Write it in your own words):

O - Observation (What do you notice?):

A - Application (How does this apply to YOUR life?):

P - Prayer (Write a prayer based on this verse):

SOAP Practice: Colossians 3:23

*"Whatever you do, work at it with all your heart, as working for the Lord,"
not for human masters.*

-- Colossians 3:23

S - Scripture (Write it in your own words):

O - Observation (What do you notice?):

A - Application (How does this apply to YOUR life?):

P - Prayer (Write a prayer based on this verse):

SOAP Practice: Deuteronomy 31:6

"Be strong and courageous. Do not be afraid, for the LORD your God goes with" you.

-- Deuteronomy 31:6

S - Scripture (Write it in your own words):

O - Observation (What do you notice?):

A - Application (How does this apply to YOUR life?):

P - Prayer (Write a prayer based on this verse):

SOAP Practice: Micah 6:8

"Act justly, love mercy, and walk humbly with your God."

-- Micah 6:8

S - Scripture (Write it in your own words):

O - Observation (What do you notice?):

A - Application (How does this apply to YOUR life?):

P - Prayer (Write a prayer based on this verse):

SOAP Practice: Romans 12:2

*"Do not conform to the pattern of this world, but be transformed by the
renewing of your mind.*

-- Romans 12:2

S - Scripture (Write it in your own words):

O - Observation (What do you notice?):

A - Application (How does this apply to YOUR life?):

P - Prayer (Write a prayer based on this verse):

SOAP Practice: 2 Timothy 1:7

"For God has not given us a spirit of fear, but of power, love, and a sound" mind.

-- 2 Timothy 1:7

S - Scripture (Write it in your own words):

O - Observation (What do you notice?):

A - Application (How does this apply to YOUR life?):

P - Prayer (Write a prayer based on this verse):

SOAP Practice: Psalm 37:4

"Delight yourself in the LORD, and He will give you the desires of your" heart.

-- Psalm 37:4

S - Scripture (Write it in your own words):

O - Observation (What do you notice?):

A - Application (How does this apply to YOUR life?):

P - Prayer (Write a prayer based on this verse):

You Did It!

"Your word is a lamp for my feet, a light on my path."

-- Psalm 119:105

Congratulations on completing this workbook! You now have the tools to study the Bible on your own. Remember: Bible study is a lifelong journey. Keep reading, keep learning, keep growing. God's Word never runs out of treasures to discover.

What's Next?

- * Join a Bible study group at your local church
- * Try reading through an entire Gospel
- * Start journaling daily using the SOAP method
- * Find an accountability partner
- * Download a Bible app for reading on the go